Loaded Baked Potato Soup

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Peel and cut potatoes into 1-inch chunks; chop bacon; dice onion; mince garlic; soften and chunk cream cheese; shred cheddar; slice green onions. Pressure cook 8 minutes on High, then quick release.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Potatoes, salt, pepper, and garlic powder; broth measured separately

- [ ] 3.5 lb russet potatoes, peeled and cut into 1-inch chunks (that's like 8 potatoes) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 8 slices bacon, chopped (1/2 pound. Maybe just cook a whole pound)
- [ ] 1 medium onion, diced
- [ ] 4 cloves garlic, minced
- [ ] 4 1/2 cups chicken broth
- [ ] 1 1/4 tsp salt, plus more to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 oz cream cheese, softened and cut into chunks
- [ ] 1 cup heavy cream
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups sharp cheddar cheese, shredded
- [ ] 1/2 cup sour cream
- [ ] 3-4 green onions, sliced

- [ ] For serving: extra cheddar, bacon, sour cream, and green onions.

1. Prepare and cook

1. Select Sauté. Cook 8 chopped bacon slices until crisp. Remove with a slotted spoon; leave about 2 tbsp bacon fat in the pot. The source notes that a whole pound of bacon may be preferred.

2. Sauté 1 diced medium onion 3-4 minutes. Add 4 minced garlic cloves and cook 30 seconds.

3. Measure 4 1/2 cups chicken broth. Add a splash from this measured total and scrape the bottom thoroughly to loosen browned bits.

4. Add 3 1/2 lb peeled russet potatoes in 1-inch chunks, all broth remaining from the measured 4 1/2 cups, 1 1/4 tsp salt, 3/4 tsp black pepper, and 1/2 tsp garlic powder.

5. Seal the Instant Pot and cook on High Pressure for 8 minutes. When finished, carefully perform a quick release.

6. Open the pot and use a potato masher to mash roughly half of the potatoes, leaving plenty of chunks.

7. Select Sauté on Low. Stir in 4 oz softened cream cheese, cut into chunks, until completely melted.

8. Stir in the 1 cup heavy cream. Let the soup warm gently for a couple of minutes, but don't let it boil aggressively.

9. Press Cancel. Stir in 1 1/2 cups shredded sharp cheddar until melted, then 1/2 cup sour cream.

10. Stir in about two-thirds of the cooked bacon and most of the 3-4 sliced green onions. Reserve the rest for topping. Adjust salt and pepper to taste.

11. Let the soup sit for 5-10 minutes before serving. It will continue to thicken as it stands.

12. Top each bowl with the reserved bacon, cheddar, green onions, and a spoonful of sour cream.